FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-27-18001

Issue Title : Nuisance Ground Spoiler Status Messages detected by the Spoiler Control Electronics

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2761-45	-8, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
03/05/2018	05/08/2019	04/22/2019
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Revision Description

All actions complete.

Article closure.

Applicability

All 737-8 and -9 aircraft prior to line number 7491.

Description

Operators have reported the Maintenance Light illuminated during preflight with a correlated maintenance message 27-01260 “GROUND SPOILER MODULE PRESSURE SWITCH INDICATION IS HIGH PRESSURE WITH LOW PRESSURE IN HYDRAULIC SYSTEM A OR WITH GROUND SPOILERS STOWED”.

Background

Fly by wire spoilers on the 737 MAX included necessary changes to the ground spoiler control system. One such change replaced the mechanically driven interlock and control valves with a single, electronic Ground Spoiler Control Module (GSCM), equipment number M2998.

On the 737 NG, the ground spoilers are controlled by the speedbrake lever through control cable inputs to the ratio changer and spoiler mixer. The ground spoiler control valve receives inputs from the spoiler mixer and sends hydraulic pressure to the ground spoiler interlock valve. When the airplane is on the ground, the interlock valve lets hydraulic fluid go to the ground spoiler actuators.

On the MAX, the ground spoilers are controlled by the Spoiler Control Electronics (SCE) through discrete commands to the GSCM. The GSCM contains two solenoid valves, an Arm valve and a Control valve. With ground and power supplied to both solenoid valves, the arm and control valves are shuttled to the open position, allowing hydraulic pressure to reach the ground spoiler actuators.

While the GSCM provides the same functionality and redundancy as the 737NG design, it minimizes the possibility of experiencing an un-commanded ground spoiler deployment due a Ground Spoiler Interlock Valve failure.

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FLEET TEAM DIGEST

Operation of Speed Brake Lever with Hydraulic power off results in hydraulic fluid being trapped between the two valves that make up the GSCM. When hydraulic power is reapplied, the trapped fluid results in the pressure sensor indicating high pressure when low pressure is expected, preventing the ground spoilers from retracting fully.

Status

Boeing has implemented a logic change in the Spoiler Control Electronics (SCE) software being installed in the 737-7 aircraft to eliminate this nuisance message. Moving the speedbrake lever with hydraulics off can leave the ground spoilers unstowed. The change will cycle the arm valve when hydraulic pressure is restored to allow the ground spoiler panels to fully retract. The new software is available on the Boeing Part Page and can be installed on all 737-8 and -9 airplanes.

Interim Action

This nuisance message can be cleared by Maintenance personnel. Maintenance should perform ground test in accordance with (IAW) FIM TASK 27-62-00-810-807, Spoiler Control, SYSTEM TEST, Ground Spoilers.

737-8 Operators should upgrade their SCE software to part number BPS26-SCE1-0102, BPS25-SCE2-0102, and BPS24-SCE3-0102. The software is available in Boeing Electronic Distribution of Software (BEDS). Operators can order it from the Boeing Part Page. The software should be installed in accordance with Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM) Task 27-61-45-470-801 “SCE Software Installation with Onboard Network System”.

Final Action

737-8 and -9 Operators should upgrade their SCE software to part number BPS27-SCE1-0103, BPS24-SCE2-0103, and BPS25-SCE3-0103. The software is available in Boeing Electronic Distribution of Software (BEDS). Operators can order it from the Boeing Part Page. The software should be installed in accordance with Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM) Task 27-61-45-470-801 “SCE Software Installation with Onboard Network System”.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: Jan. 2018 (complete)

Solution Selected: Feb. 2018 (complete)

Change Committed: FEB. 2018 (complete)

Production Incorporation (-8 / -0102): April 2018 (LN 6895)

IPC Revised (-0102): November 2018 (complete)

Service Letter 737-SL-27-274: January 24, 2019 (complete)

Production Incorporation: (-8 and -9 / -0103) March 14, 2019 (complete)

Service Bulletin 737-27-1309: April 5, 2019 (complete)

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Part Information

The reference SL states the 737-9 baseline SCE software (-0102) can replace but not be replaced (one way interchangeable) by the 737-8 baseline SCE software (-0101). The set of BPS26-SCE1-0102, BPS25-SCE2-0102, and BPS24-SCE3-0102 can replace but not be replaced by the set of BPS25-SCE1-0101, BPS26-SCE2-0101, and BPS27-SCE3-0101 for all 737-8 MAX aircraft.

The reference SB will state the 737-7 baseline SCE software (-0103) can replace, on 737-8 and -9, but not be replaced (one way interchangeable) by the 737-9 baseline SCE software (-0102). The set of BPS27-SCE1-0103, BPS24-SCE2-0103, and BPS25-SCE3-0103 can replace but not be replaced by the set of BPS25-SCE1-0101, BPS26-SCE2-0101, and BPS27-SCE3-0101 or BPS26-SCE1-0102, BPS25-SCE2-0102, and BPS24-SCE3-0102 for all 737-8 and -9 MAX aircraft.

Affected Documents

The aircraft Illustrated Parts Catalog (IPC) will be updated to include interchangeability information.

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Letter (SL)	737-SL-27-274		01/24/2019
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-27-1309		03/29/2019

Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
Spoiler Control Electronics		BAE Systems	115E6352G1
Spoiler Control Electronics		BAE Systems	115E6352G2

Related Categories

- Dispatch Reliability Issues : Issues that cause revenue flight delays and cancellations
- Flight Deck Effects and Maintenance Messages : Issue that occurs frequently and causes a flight deck effect or maintenance message

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